

best Android device ever” discussions on tech forums that contributed a lot to the hype train, soon sort of petered out due to many of the members not being able to get their hands on one. And once the stocks issues got sorted out, the technical issues came along. Bluetooth connections were flaky at best, cellular coverage was less than spectacular, microphones failed, batteries were a hit or miss... a long laundry list of complaints bogged up forums -- with the main criticism being that these cost too much to be having these many problems. But the issues can be slightly forgiven, since this was Google's first foray into a smart-phone. And they did acquit themselves well, with most of the problems being addressed in software upgrades down the line (except for the price front, but then again Google is gunning for the premium flagship category).

In the end, the Pixel and the Pixel XL were undoubtedly good phones especially when you consider they are the first of their kind. They are everything a Nexus phone was (except for the great bang for buck value of the earlier Nexus'... Nexii? Nexuses?) and then some. They created some healthy competition in their price segment instead of people just deciding between the iPhone and a Samsung Galaxy (with some outliers venturing to LG) and more competition is always

a good thing, especially if a powerful stalwart like Google joins the ring. The biggest gripe people had with the Pixel was the co-opting of the design. The Pixel looked more like a Nexus device than a phone 'made by Google'. We mean, keep an HTC A9 and the Pixel side-by-side. Uncanny resemblance no? But this too was excused as a rookie mistake coming from a first time smartphone manufacturer. Apart from that, the Pixels had a few other minor shortcomings like the lack of waterproofing but nothing so major that the next iterative release won't smooth over, and thus, almost a year later, the whole tech community waited eagerly (and impatiently, the leaks caused quite a stir) for the Pixel 2.



The Pixel XL was surprisingly wieldy for its size